

CODEC CHEAT SHEET

Codec	Supported Bit Rates	Special Features	Downsides	High-Res Audio Support
SBC	up to 345kbps (theoretically)	Low power consumption Low processing power required	Latency Issues Compressed audio	No
AAC	up to 320kbps	Better compression than SBC	Not in the open domain Uses more power and processing	No
aptX	up to 384kbps	Better compression algorithm than SBC	Not supported on iOS	Yes
aptX HD	up to 576kbps	Improvement over aptX Higher bit rate and bit depth than aptX	Not supported on iOS	Yes
aptX LL	up to 352kbps	Low latency (about 32ms)	Not supported on smartphones	No
LDAC	up to 990kbps	Supports High-Res Audio Better support for Android devices	Proprietary Sony technology Limited presence in the market	Yes
ALAC	approx. 1411kbps	Supports lossless audio	Limited to Apple devices	Yes

speaker or a soundbar, you experience it yourself. Go to a store and play a few demos of the content that you are most likely to consume. As a reviewer, I cannot give you a sound signature to look out for, only because someone consuming a lot of heavy metal music would not like a bass-forward sound, and so on and so forth. So, experience before you buy.

2 Few but well implemented

When starting out this section of the article, I mentioned that core features are more or less the same across price brackets these days. That is why, you need to make sure that the features being offered on the soundbar or speaker you are looking for, are well implemented.

Some of the key features in the soundbar that you should look out for are -

- Sub-woofer and satellite speaker support
- Dolby Atmos and DTS:X support
- App support (For tuning and control)
- 4K pass-through (If needed) and I/O options (more the merrier)
- Size and mounting options

Some of the key features that you should look out for when buying speakers are -

- App support
- Voice Assistant Integration
- Physical/Remote Control
- On-device tuning and controls (Bass, Treble, and volume controls)
- Battery capacity
- Daisy chaining capabilities (Will allow you to connect multiple speakers to create a truly wireless stereo setup)

3 Size and build

If you are someone who moves around with their speakers or your soundbar is exposed to unwanted elements often, then you should definitely keep an eye out for the build materials that are being used in your product. In speakers, a solid plastic

body with a metal/plastic grill and a carrying handle is something that you should keep an eye out for. If you are stepping out with your speakers, then you should keep the IP ratings in mind as well.

In terms of soundbars, plastic body for the bars is a norm, but if you get a wooden construction on the subwoofer, then it is better. Mesh covering on the front of the bar is something I would say you should avoid if your bar is susceptible to dust accumulation or knicks and cuts. A metal grill would be the way to go.

And, when in doubt, reach out to us. Drop an email at editor@digit.in or satvik@digit.in and we'd be happy to help! **d**

